

Heenal Kishor Patel

Computer Engineering

Company: HyperVerge

Job Profile: Associate Product Manager Intern

Offer Type: 6 months Internship + Performance based PPO

Internship Stipend: ₹30,000 per month

CTC: 12-16 LPA

Location: Bangalore/Mumbai

Process Dates:

- **6 Aug 2025:** Pre Placement Talk (Online)
- **7 Aug 2025:** Case Study PS Released(8 pm)
- **11 Aug 2025:** Case Study Submission(4 pm)
- **13 Aug 2025:** Tech Interview(Online)
- **14 Aug 2025:** HR Interview(Online)

Resume: at the time of applying:  Heenal_Resume-54.pdf

Placement Process:

1. **Case Study Round** [86 candidates appeared from SPIT. The process was conducted simultaneously at both SPIT and KJ Somaiya, the total number of candidates was approx 200+]

We were provided with a **Notion file containing two problem statements**. The final deliverables for both were:

- **A presentation deck (PDF format)**
- **A short video presentation (max 5 mins)** that shows both you and the deck. In the video explain your approach to problem framing and how you developed the solution

We had to choose one among the following two problem statements:

Problem Statement 1:

Design a Lightweight KYC App for Bharat

Context:

You are the Associate Product Manager at a tech startup building digital onboarding solutions. Your company is launching a mobile app targeting rural and semi-urban India, where smartphone specs are low-end, bandwidth is limited and users may not be digitally literate.

The app must support:

- Digilocker-based KYC
- Document-based KYC (Aadhaar, PAN, DL, VoterID)
- Face authentication (liveness, facematch checks)
- Integration with other client apps (SDK integration, web-redirection, etc.)
- Offline & retry-friendly mode

Your Task: Design the KYC solution end-to-end, keeping in mind the following:

1. Product Design & UX:

- How will the app work for users with low digital literacy?
- What will the user flow look like (screens, guidance, fail-safes)? Create wireframes.
- What offline/low-network support will you offer?

2. Features:

- Suggest and implement 2-3 innovative features to improve trust or ease of use using LLMs.
- How will you prioritise which features to build? Create a Prioritisation Matrix

3. Technical Architecture:

- How will you optimize SDK size?
- What trade-offs will you make between on-device vs server-side processing (e.g., facematch, liveness)?
- How will you handle low bandwidth and retry/resume flows?

4. Miscellaneous:

- How would you measure the success of the app?
- Any security concerns and how you'll solve them?

Problem Statement 2:

AI-Enabled Loan Underwriting Agent for Rural and Semi-Urban India

Context:

You are an Associate Product Manager at a tech startup developing lending solutions. Your company is launching a mobile app designed for rural and semi-urban India. The app must work reliably on low-spec smartphones, work with limited bandwidth, and be user-friendly for individuals with low digital literacy.

The app must support:

- Instant Personal Loans
- AI enabled underwriting and lending
- Low customer default rates

Your Task: Design an end-to-end Loan Underwriting solution taking into account the following key areas:

- **Features:**
 - What specific problems will your solution address? How will you prioritise the most important problems?
 - Create two to three innovative features powered by LLMs(Eg: AI agents, Dynamic orchestrators) that can improve underwriting accuracy or ease of use
 - How will you decide which features should be built first? Provide a clear prioritisation matrix
- **Product Design and User Experience:**
 - How will the app accommodate users with low digital literacy?
 - Describe the user flow for every step of the journey (To be created for every feature)
 - Create Wireframes showcasing this solution (To be created for every feature)
- **Technical Architecture:**
 - Present a high level system design architecture that supports your AI enabled underwriting feature
 - Explain how you will handle low bandwidth environments, especially retry and resume logic to ensure a seamless experience
- **Additional Considerations:**
 - How will you define and measure success for the app (including key performance indicators)?
 - What security concerns must you address, and how will you mitigate them?

NOTE: For both of the ps, we were allowed to use LLMs or AI tools such as Lovable for ideation. But the final submission must be fully original.

My approach for this round:

- **Selecting the problem statement:**
 - During the presentation, it was evident that the company emphasized KYC, since that aligns with their core use case.
 - Based on this, I chose Problem Statement 1 – Design a Lightweight KYC App for Bharat.
- **Initial research and documentation:**
 - Before jumping into deck preparation, I conducted thorough research.
 - Explored articles, government research reports, and examined existing government KYC apps in detail.
 - Captured all useful insights and points in a structured document.
- **Preparing the deck:**
 - Once the research and documentation were complete, I began working on the presentation deck.
 - There was no page limit specified, so I created a comprehensive 15-page deck.
 - I structured the flow using the CUPS-PDM framework for clarity and coherence.

Deck structure using CUPS-PDM:

- **Context:** Included all research findings, statistics, and key numbers to set the stage.
 - **User Personas:** Defined different user types, highlighting their characteristics and specific problems.
 - **Problems:** Listed all issues, clearly showing their cause and effect relationships.
 - **Solution:**
 - Designed solutions feature-wise, ensuring each one addressed previously identified problems as well as the pain points in the problem statement.
 - Included LLM-powered features to demonstrate how these can make the KYC process more efficient and convenient.
 - **Wireframes:**
 - Since AI tools were allowed, I used v0 by Vercel to create wireframes.
 - Prepared a detailed document specifying app design guidelines – from colors, buttons, and icons to text and overall flow to give it as a prompt.
 - Added all generated screens into the deck to visualize the user journey.
 - **Technical Architecture:**
 - Built a very detailed architecture slide, focusing on what, why, and how each approach would solve the problem.
 - Covered all pain points mentioned in the problem statement.
 - **Metrics:** Concluded with success metrics to measure the impact of the solution.
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- **Key principle followed:**
 - I ensured every single detail in the deck had a clear justification.
 - Avoided adding features blindly — everything was backed by reasoning, research, and alignment with user needs.

Key Takeaways for Preparing the PPT:

- Avoid long paragraphs; use bullet points for clarity.
- Choose neat, professional fonts that are easy to read.
- Use icons and images wherever possible to make slides lively and colorful.
- Add light-colored background boxes behind text to differentiate sections on a page.
- Maintain a consistent heading style on every slide.
- Stick to a uniform color palette throughout to give a cohesive look.
- Start with a minimalist Canva template to save time.
- Avoid wasting time on animations — since the final submission is PDF, animations won't be visible and take extra effort to set up.
- Use varied slide layouts for different sections to keep it engaging.
- Include as many icons as possible for better visibility and quick understanding.

5-Minute Presentation Video : My Advice and Experience

- **Record in a proper environment:**
 - Wear a formal shirt and present in a quiet place with no disturbance.
 - Do not leave this task for the last minute – it looks short but can take multiple takes to get right.
- **Be prepared for technical issues:**
 - You may face network problems, mic glitches, or recording errors, so keep buffer time.
 - In my early attempts, I froze on camera and lost track of what to say — this is normal, but plan for it.
- **Keep your delivery natural:**
 - Don't write or read a script – it's obvious and makes you sound robotic.
 - If needed, keep a small note of points to maintain flow instead of memorizing word-for-word.
 - Speak calmly, explain your thought process, and pitch the product naturally.
- **Focus on the flow of content:**
 - In 5 minutes, highlight why you chose this approach and how it impacts the problem statement.
 - Do not just read from the PPT – explain rather than narrate slides.
 - Keep it conversational but structured so it feels confident and authentic.
- **Watch your timing carefully:**
 - In my initial recordings, I overshot to 12–15 minutes, which forced multiple retakes.
 - Practice summarizing to stay within 5 minutes.
- **Tools I used:**
 - I used Zoom to record, presenting the PPT side-by-side with me visible.

2. Domain Knowledge Interviews (Online) [5 candidates appeared for this round]

Preparation:

- Having **justification for every word in my case study**.
- Anticipating **all types of questions related to my case study**.
- Revisiting **core product management concepts** (since this round was domain-focused).
- Practicing **redesigns and new feature ideas** for commonly used apps (WhatsApp, Instagram, food delivery apps, Google Drive).
- Learning how to answer **trade-off questions** in a **structured manner**.
- Reviewing **every project and internship** on my resume.
- Preparing approaches for **puzzle questions** and **guesstimates**.

Interview Experience:

- **Duration:** 1 Hour
- **Mode:** Online (Google Meet)

The interviewer began by introducing himself and then asked me to introduce myself. One of the first questions was:

Being a computer science student with so many hackathon experiences, why product management?

I had prepared for this. I explained that I was always more interested in **user-centric thinking**, fascinated by how apps are **designed and tailored for different users**, and that I enjoy working on **Figma designs**. In hackathons, my approach was always to present solutions **not just as projects, but as complete products** with thorough research, wireframes, and business models, which gave my teams an edge.

Case Study Discussion:

The interviewer shared his screen with my PPT and asked me to present it. I followed the same calm, natural approach I used in my video presentation but went deeper into the reasoning behind each decision.

- He asked **how I gathered the information** and **why I chose this approach**.
- I realized that **every word I used could become a question**, so I spoke very carefully.

He asked: **What is an SDK, and why would a company use it instead of building one themselves?**

- I first explained what an SDK is.
- Then I justified with examples: *E-commerce apps use PhonePe or Razorpay SDKs because payments aren't their primary focus. Similarly, apps integrate Google Sign-In to save time and resources.*
- This reasoning with examples impressed him.

Prioritization and Metrics Question:

He then asked: **If you had to choose between two features : photo verification vs offline-first, which would you prioritize as a PM, and on what basis?**

I explained using the **impact vs effort framework**:

1. First discuss feasibility and required resources with the tech team.
2. Conduct user research to gauge impact and need.
3. Align the decision with **company goals**.

4. Choose the feature that **balances user needs and business objectives**.

Business & Market Thinking:

Next, he asked: **If you had to take a ride, would you choose Ola or Uber? State three metrics.**

I answered:

- Ratings/reviews
- Time to reach
- Pricing (including coupons/deals)

Puzzle Question:

The puzzle: **101 coins, one counterfeit, identify in two weighings if it's lighter or heavier.**

- I began by **noting down key points and clarifying constraints**.
- I divided the coins into three groups of 33, with 2 coins left aside, and explained **different cases step by step**.
- He was satisfied with my systematic approach.

Guesstimate Question:

The guesstimate: **How many fine dining restaurants are there in Mumbai?**

- I first **asked clarifying questions** (big restaurants only or small ones too?).
- He said only **fine dining restaurants**, so I based my estimate on **Mumbai's 600 sq km area**.
- I used my local knowledge: In a 1 km area near my home, there are about **12 restaurants**. In some areas, maybe **4–5**, and in upscale areas like Powai, around **15**.
- I took an **average of 10 per sq km** → **~6000 restaurants**.
- Initially, I wrongly assumed distance as the unit (thinking from my house as center), then corrected it to **area-based reasoning**, which I explained clearly.
- He appreciated how I **self-corrected and justified the change in approach**.

Closing the Interview:

At the end, I was asked if I had any questions. **Always prepare 2–3 thoughtful questions beforehand**, never say “no,” as it shows lack of interest.

I asked:

Product managers are often called the CEO of a product, but what do they actually own? What are their responsibilities?

The interviewer gave a **detailed explanation** in response.

3. **Culture Fit Round** [1 candidate appeared for this round]

I was the **only candidate selected** for this final round.

The interview was **online on Google Meet**, lasting around **45 minutes**. Compared to the earlier rounds, this was **much more chill and relaxed**. The interviewer emphasized that he wanted **honest answers**, so don't take much time and say whatever comes to you naturally.

The interviewer asked me to **describe my journey from the start**.

- I began with my passion for design, and how tough it was initially to adjust in an environment where I felt lost.
- Over time, my interest grew towards UI/UX, leading me to take freelance projects, internships, and hackathon experiences.
- I also spoke about being Head of Events at WIE-IEEE, which involved strategic thinking, event planning, budgeting, and making events engaging to attract people.
- I shared how pitching to stalls for the Women's Week event helped me better understand stakeholder needs.
- Taking hackathon projects beyond just code and bugs, and presenting them as complete products with design and business aspects, deepened my passion for product management.

Key Questions and My Responses:

- **You've done 5 internships in 6 months , why so many? Wasn't one enough?How did you prioritize tasks? Wasn't it overburdening?**

I explained that I never treated internships as just tasks to meet deadlines. Design is something I love, so it never felt like a burden. I can spend hours on Figma, presentations, and product design and that enthusiasm drives me. The interviewer appreciated this perspective. I clarified that my focus was on learning and impact rather than just ticking off tasks, which kept me motivated and balanced.

- **Tell me about your best friend in college, what would they say about your strengths and weaknesses?**

I gave an honest answer about how my friends perceive me, highlighting collaboration, creativity, and persistence as strengths, and mentioning areas I actively work to improve.

- **As a product manager, what would you like to spend most of your time doing?**

I explained that I would love to focus on user research, product strategy, and translating insights into design decisions, because that's where I feel I add the most value.

- **If you had abundant money, would you still want to work? If yes, what would you do?**

I said I'm a creative person who can't sit idle.

- I would probably teach Figma or create a product management roadmap on YouTube.

- I would take a world tour to explore ideas and experiences.
- If I had significant resources, I would start my own startup, which the interviewer liked.

- **Looking at our website, what would you improve in its UI?**

I suggested keeping the color palette and tone as it is but adding a subtle AI-inspired design touch such as a glowing element in the logo or subtle interactive visuals to make it look distinctly AI-driven. The interviewer appreciated this as a unique idea.

- **With so many skills and achievements, why is your CGPA 8 and not higher?**

I explained that I believe real learning happens outside the classroom. I chose to invest my time and prioritized building practical skills, taking internships, participating in hackathons, and gaining real experience over chasing high marks in subjects that were less relevant to my career path.

- **Which is your least and most favorite subject?**

I answered honestly: Computer Communication Networks (CCN) as my least favorite and Design Thinking as my most favorite because of its user-centric problem-solving approach.

At the end, he asked if I had any questions. I prepared in advance and asked:

1. What would my typical day look like as a product manager?
2. What are the top three skills required to contribute effectively as a product manager?

This wrapped up the interview on a positive note.

Finally, I was the only one getting the offer (including both SPIT and Somaiya).

Useful Tips:

My Experience and Key Lessons:

Placements are honestly all about **luck, timing, and having faith in yourself**. My experience was nothing less than a rollercoaster ride. I got shortlisted for almost every company in resume screening, cleared several online assessments, and reached multiple interviews — but I also made **silly mistakes** that cost me offers early on.

Then came **14th August — the day everything changed**. This morning, I was giving interviews for Baker Hughes. My technical round went really well, and within 10 minutes, I was called for the HR round which also surprisingly went smooth. By noon, I was told my chances of getting selected were very high.

In the middle, I got the message: ***I was the only student shortlisted for the final round with Hyperverge from their entire Mumbai drive.*** I was happy, but also very confused — which one to choose?

Around **3.30 pm** I had been selected by **Baker Hughes** ,but with great support from TPO, especially **Zeeshan Sir**, the company agreed to let me decide after the results.

So, while everyone else was celebrating after Baker Hughes, I was baffled and busy preparing for my Hyperverge interview.

By evening, I had **offers from both companies**. It was a tough choice — one was a core tech role, the other was an APM role that aligned with my passion. I **listened to my heart and finally chose Hyperverge**.

- **Believe in timing**. Even after multiple rejections, the right role will come at the right time.
- Keep your **LinkedIn profile updated** — companies really do check it.
- Be **thoroughly familiar with your resume** — every point should be something you can explain confidently.
- For **puzzles and brainteasers**, practicing from **GeeksforGeeks puzzles** is more than enough [Top 100 Puzzles Asked In Interviews - GeeksforGeeks](#)
- During the interview, **stay calm and confident** — don't overthink or try to be someone you're not.
- **Be yourself** — authenticity leaves a lasting impression.
- For Guestimates I used this: [Guesstimate Framework](#)
- I used this to go through specific topics and tools related to product management,don't read the entire doc (it's way too long and bloated) just take a glance and see those only those topics which you need to study: [Complete APM Tools Study Guide](#)
- You can contact me any time for any help and guidance:
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/heenal-patel-447772283/> | [8657094834](https://www.instagram.com/8657094834)

It's a very tough phase, but remember this too shall pass.

Wishing you all the best for your placements!